f) Feeling tired and depressed.
g) High on anxiety.
h) Low self-esteem and worthlessness

Adjustments in old age

Some of the adjustments people have to make as they move into old age include:

Health adjustment: One of the threats to the elderly is prolonged illness. The aging body is highly vulnerable to ravaging diseases and injury. The psychological stressors of old age can also provoke psychological disorders.

Adjustment to retirement – Retirement is separation from a sphere of activity that has provided special social order, economic remuneration, personal identity and prestige for many years. The abrupt termination of one's livelihood may be a great threat to the old people; a welcome relief to some from tedious thankless jobs or a natural conclusion of one's successful career. It may provide more time for some to pursue their dreams and pleasurable activities

1st October is celebrated as the International Day for Elderly People each year.

Coping with the Problems Faced During Old Age

Different people adopt different coping strategies to meet their life challenges. Some of the effective coping strategies may be summarized as follows:

1. The elderly need to develop an attitude of flexibility so that they may adapt to life's pressures and problems of old age.
2. They need to recognize that they have to explore new ways of coping with their life events.
3. The elderly need to make greater use of "information seeking" and of "problem solving" rather than withdrawing or isolating.
4. They need to enhance their self-confidence, self reliance, develop healthy attitude about their strengths and weaknesses as well as learning and maintaining effective coping skills
5. Participate in various group activities such as joining clubs and certain organizations for informal social interaction is very helpful for the aged.
6. Involvement in grand parenting helps the elderly satisfy many of their personal and emotional needs.

SUMMARY

- Human development and its challenges deals with the various stages of the life span a human being goes through from infancy to old age.
- It includes the changes (physical, emotional, social and cognitive) in the life cycle of an individual and the various developmental tasks in each stage.
- Specific areas of concern such as juvenile delinquency, its causes and rehabilitation measures have been addressed.
- Emphasis has been given to children with special needs including those who are visually challenged, mentally challenged, orthopedically challenged, hearing and speech impaired with specific reference to the various difficulties they face along with coping mechanisms.

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